

BLUNDERMIND

Bot Controls — Technical Project Brief

Move Selection Mechanics, Formulas & Architecture

All controls described are available in the `bot-control-panel.html` sidebar. Formulas reference `src/50-bot-engine.js` and `src/60-bot-ui.js`. This brief reflects the state of the dev branch as of July 2026.

Section	Topic
1	Architecture Overview — Move Selection Pipeline
2	Move Source Layer (Opening Book / Maia3 / Stockfish / LCSE)
3	Think Time Calculation
4	Time Pressure Play Degradation (Independent Curves A & B)
5	Temperature & Move Sampling
6	Strategic Attractors (Centipawmeter)
7	Piece-Type Attractors
8	Move Distribution Filter & Luck
9	CP-Budget Acceptance & Degradation Guard (Engine-Verified)
10	Draw & Desperation Behaviours
11	Preset Personalities
12	Time Controls
13	Human Behaviour Flags
14	Appendix — Play From Any Position (Replay / Loaded Games / Invites)

1. Architecture Overview — Move Selection Pipeline

Every bot move passes through the sequential stages below. Each stage can veto, modify, or short-circuit to skip later stages. The stages run in strict order so that think time — computed in Stage 2 — feeds every downstream degradation calculation, and so the final engine-verification stages (8–9) see the move the personality actually chose.

Stage	Name	What happens
1	Opening Book	ECO table lookup (preferred) or Lichess Masters API (mainline). If a matching move is found, it is played immediately after a brief book check.
2	Think Time	Actual think time for this move computed from timing mode + Hustle attractor + clock pressure. Result fed as thinkSec into all downstream degradation calculations.
3	Engine Query	Rough thinkSec estimate used to pick Maia ELO (curve A, if the ELO-degradation toggle is on). Maia3 or LCSF queried for candidate moves.
4	Distribution Filter	Absolute min-probability floor removes near-zero candidates. Curve B (if the distribution toggle is on) narrows the upper percentile; the rest of the distribution is flattened.
5	Attractor Reweighting	Each candidate move's probability is multiplied by $\exp(\text{logBoost})$ where logBoost is the sum of all active strategic attractor signals. Set to zero if the move is illegal.
6	Desperation (opt.)	If "seek stalemate when losing" is armed and the engine eval confirms a lost position, candidate weights are re-shaped toward low-own-piece-count moves.
7	Temperature Sampling	Final temperature applied (base T × phase/pressure modifiers). One move sampled from the reweighted distribution.
8	CP-Budget Acceptance	Personality bots only: if the sampled pick differs from Maia's most-popular move, a shallow Stockfish probe checks that the pick loses to the popular move.
9	Degradation Guard	Bad-Day / distribution-restricted picks are re-checked so a degraded choice can never out-perform Maia's top move — popularity is not a guarantee.

Key architectural principle #1 — think time drives degradation: Think time is computed first (Stage 2), and the resulting thinkSec value drives Stages 3–4 via the degradation curves. A Coffeehouse Hustler thinking 0.3 s on a move sees heavy ELO and distribution degradation on that specific move — not an average derived from the remaining clock.

Key architectural principle #2 — real centipawns, not probability: Maia probability measures how *popular* a move is at a rating, which is not the same as how *good* it is — at low ratings the two can even anticorrelate. Therefore the CP budget and all quality guarantees are enforced with actual Stockfish evaluations at Stages 8–9, never by treating a probability ratio as a centipawn value. These probes run only for personality bots and are fail-open (any probe timeout leaves the sampled move untouched).

2. Move Source Layer

2a. Opening Book

Two independent book modes are available. Either can be active simultaneously; each deactivates permanently the first time it fails to find a candidate move.

Mode	Source	Behaviour
Preferred	In-memory ECO table (~3 000 named openings)	Plays the ne game history against ECO lines whose ECO code or family prefix is in the bot's slot list.
Mainline	Lichess Masters API (live)	Queries masters database for the most popular continuation from the current position. Falls back to Lichess d

Book delay: 400–1200 ms random pause to simulate human reading time.

2b. Maia3 Neural Network

Maia3 is a series of neural networks (600–2600 ELO) trained to predict human moves at each rating level. The bot queries the appropriate ELO model (determined by degradation curve A) and receives a probability distribution over all legal moves.

- Model selection: `effective ELO = pressureEffectiveMaiaEloByThink(thinkSec)`
- ELO clamped to [600, 2600].
- Probability distribution filtered by quality range (§8), then reweighted by attractors (§6).

2c. Stockfish (SF) Engine

Used when the bot engine mode is set to Stockfish. Skill level 1–20 controlled by `sfEffectiveLevel()`. The engine is queried via WebWorker; MultiPV probes provide complexity scores used by the Chaos attractor.

```
sfEffectiveLevel: floor = pressureFloor pressureFloor = max(1, startLevel - round(timePressureMaxDrop / 50)) (or the sfPressureLevel slider when no max-drop is set)
```

The old blunder-limit-derived quality floor was removed together with the hard-floor control — single-move quality is now guaranteed by the engine-verified CP budget (§9), not by a Stockfish skill floor.

Time degradation path (highest priority wins):

- Weaponizer active AND bot is ahead → return floor immediately
- Curve A present → spline interpolation in log-time space → lerp level to floor
- Fallback: linear ramp from `startLevel` at 30 s → floor at 0 s

2d. Level-Controlled Stockfish (LCSF)

LCSF uses Stockfish with controlled skill variation rather than Maia probability distributions. `sfPickLevel()` distributes calls around the target level:

```
p(offset) distribution: -2: var2/2 (e.g. 10% at ±2 → 5% chance) -1: var1/2 (e.g. 30% at ±1 → 15% chance) 0: 1 - var1 - var2 (remaining probability) +1: var1/2 +2: var2/2 Level clamped to [1, 20]
```

var1 (±1 spread): 0–50%. **var2** (±2 spread): 0–20%. Setting both to 0 uses the exact target level every move.

3. Think Time Calculation

Think time is calculated in `botThinkTime(moveProbs, clockMs)` before the engine is queried. The result (`thinkSec`) drives all downstream degradation curves, so attractors that shorten think time (Hustler) directly increase move-quality degradation for that specific move.

3a. Timing Modes

Mode	Formula / Behaviour
Instant	Returns 0 ms. No delay whatsoever.
Fixed	$\text{thinkMs} = \text{botFixedDelayMs}$. Capped at $\min(\text{fixed}, \text{clockMs} \times 0.08)$ when $\text{clock} < 30$ s. Capped at $\text{clockMs} - 3$ s when flagging is disabled.
Pace (default)	$\text{baseSec} = (5 \times 60) / \text{pace}$. $\text{complexity} = \min(1 + \text{entropy} \times 0.35, 2.5)$. $\text{thinkMs} = \text{baseSec} \times \text{complexity} \times 1000$. Pace slider: 5–120 (moves per 5 s).
Complexity	$\text{cplx} = \text{sfCplxScore}$ if available, else $\min(1, \text{entropy} / 4)$. $\text{mult} = \text{botCplxMin} + \text{cplx} \times (\text{botCplxMax} - \text{botCplxMin})$. $\text{thinkMs} = \text{botCplxBase} \times \text{mult} \times 1000$.
Mirror	$\text{avg} = \text{rolling average of human move timestamps}$. $\text{thinkMs} = \text{avg} \times \text{jitter}(0.8\text{--}1.2) \times (1 + \text{mirrorOffsetPct}/100)$. Falls through to Complexity/Pace v.

3b. Think Time Modifiers (applied in order)

Modifier	Condition	Effect
Weaponizer shortcut	Enabled AND $\text{bot clock} > \text{opp clock} + \text{leadMs}$	$\text{thinkMs} = 0$ ms immediately (skip all delays)
Move blink	botBehavBlink AND $\text{entropy} < 0.5$ (forced 200–500 suspensions)	skips further calculation
Clock-pressure mirroring	$\text{botBehavClockMirror}$ AND $\text{oppClock} < \text{botClock} \times 0.5$	$\text{thinkMs} \times= 0.5$
Hustle attractor	value $v \in [-5, +5]$	$\text{thinkMs} \times= (1 - v \times 0.15)$. At +5: $\times 0.25$ (very fast). At –5: $\times 1.75$ (very slow).
Reconsideration	$\text{botBehavReconsider}$, 15% random chance	$\text{thinkMs} \times= 1.5$ to 2.5 (hesitation pause)
Base jitter	Always applied	$\text{thinkMs} \times= \text{uniform}(0.8, 1.2)$
Clock cap (low clock)	$\text{clockMs} < 30\,000$ ms	$\text{thinkMs} = \min(\text{thinkMs}, \text{clockMs} \times 0.08)$
Flagging guard	$\text{botCanFlag} = \text{false}$	$\text{thinkMs} = \min(\text{thinkMs}, \max(200, \text{clockMs} - 3000))$
Global cap	Always applied	$\text{thinkMs} = \max(200, \min(\text{botThinkCapMs}(), \text{thinkMs}))$. Cap = $\max(6\text{ s}, \min(45\text{ s}, \text{startClock} \times 0.02))$ –

Position entropy is Shannon entropy over Maia move probabilities: $H = -\sum p \cdot \log_2(p)$. Higher entropy = more complex / branching position.

4. Time Pressure Play Degradation

Two independent user-editable spline curves control how the bot's play quality degrades as think time per move decreases. Both curves use log-scale interpolation on the X axis (think time in seconds) so that the visually equal spacing on the panel matches the mathematical interpolation.

Each curve has its own ON/OFF toggle beside its chart, so the two mechanisms are fully independent: ELO degradation (curve A) reduces the Maia ELO the engine is queried at, while distribution restriction (curve B) keeps the ELO fixed but narrows which slice of Maia's move distribution is available. You can run either alone, both together, or switch both off for constant strength. When a curve is off it is flat at its reference value (curve A at the configured ELO, curve B at 100%), and its slider no longer re-anchors the other curve.

```
Curve interpolation (log-x space): pts sorted by x. For xSec in [pts[i].x, pts[i+1].x]: t = (ln(xSec) - ln(pts[i].x)) / (ln(pts[i+1].x) - ln(pts[i].x)) y = pts[i].y + t * (pts[i+1].y - pts[i].y)
```

Curve A — ELO Degradation

Maps think time (s) → effective Maia ELO. At full think time the bot queries its configured ELO tier. As think time shrinks the ELO drops, producing weaker move distributions.

```
effectiveELO = pressureEffectiveMaiaEloByThink(thinkSec) = evalPressureCurve(curveA, thinkSec) clamped to [600, 2600]
```

- X axis: think time per move in seconds (log scale, typically 0.1 s – 30 s)
- Y axis: Maia ELO (600 – 2600)
- Default: flat at configured ELO (no degradation) unless curve is set

The rough thinkSec estimate (computed before the Maia query) is used for ELO selection. The precise thinkSec (after the engine responds) is used for curve B and temperature.

Curve B — Distribution Cutoff

Maps think time (s) → upper percentile cutoff of the move candidate list. 100% = full distribution (top candidate down to last). As think time falls the cutoff drops — forcing the bot to pick from a narrower top slice of the distribution (higher-probability, safer-looking moves).

```
effectiveUpperPct = pressureEffectiveDayUpperByThink(thinkSec) = min(botDayUpper, evalPressureCurve(curveB, thinkSec))
```

- X axis: think time per move in seconds (log scale)
- Y axis: upper percentile 0–100%
- Combined with the Move Quality Range lower bound and Luck shift (§8)

Time Pressure Temperature Boost

In addition to ELO and distribution effects, low think time raises the sampling temperature, making move selection more random under pressure:

```
timePressureTempByThink(baseTemp, thinkSec): boost = { steady: 0.0, normal: 1.0, panicky: 2.5 }[botTimePressure] if curveB present: fraction = 1 - evalPressureCurve(curveB, thinkSec) / 100 else: fraction = max(0, 1 - thinkSec / 30) # linear fallback effectiveTemp = baseTemp + fraction * boost
```

botTimePressure modes: "steady" (no boost), "normal" (+1.0 max), "panicky" (+2.5 max).

5. Temperature & Move Sampling

After attractor reweighting, one move is sampled from the distribution using temperature-scaled probabilities. Temperature T controls how peaked or flat the distribution is before sampling.

```
sampleFromProbs(moveProbs, T): scaled[m] = prob[m] ^ (1/T) total =  $\Sigma$  scaled[m] sample  $r \sim \text{Uniform}(0, \text{total})$  return first m where cumulative sum  $\geq r$ 
```

At $T=1.0$ the original Maia probabilities are used directly. $T < 1$ sharpens the distribution (top move more likely). $T > 1$ flattens it (unlikely moves become relatively more likely). T is clamped to ≥ 0.1 to prevent division issues.

5a. Base Temperature Presets

Preset	T value	Behaviour
Focused	0.4	Strongly favours top 1–2 Maia moves
Neutral	1.0	Samples Maia's full distribution as-is
Varied	1.8	Wider sample — more surprise choices
Wild	3.0	Even low-probability moves get meaningful weight

5b. Hustler Phase Temperature

When the Coffeehouse Hustler personality is active (`personalityId = "hustler"`), the base temperature is replaced by a phase-sensitive curve:

```
hustlerPhaseTemp(): piecesLeft = count of non-pawn, non-king pieces on board fraction = clamp( $1 - (\text{piecesLeft} - 4) / 10$ , 0, 1) # 0 at 14 pieces (opening), 1 at  $\leq 4$  pieces (endgame)  $T = 5.0 + \text{fraction} \times (0.6 - 5.0) = 5.0$  in opening  $\rightarrow 0.6$  in endgame
```

14 non-pawn/non-king pieces = full material. At 4 or fewer such pieces, the endgame temperature floor of 0.6 is reached.

5c. Complexity-Adjusted Temperature

For Maia3 mode, the base temperature can optionally be scaled by position complexity (MultiPV evaluation spread):

```
complexityAdjustedTemp(baseT): if sfCplxScore is null  $\rightarrow$  return baseT cplxFactor =  $0.8 + \text{sfCplxScore} \times 0.4$  # 0.8 at simple, 1.2 at complex return baseT  $\times$  cplxFactor
```

sfCplxScore is the normalized std. deviation of the top-N Stockfish evaluations, ranging 0 (all moves equal) to 1 (widely spread evaluations).

6. Strategic Attractors (Centipawmeter)

Strategic attractors reweight each candidate move's probability by multiplying it by $\exp(\log\text{Boost})$. The total $\log\text{Boost}$ for a move is the sum of all active attractor contributions. Attractors are zero at centre and scale linearly with slider value (–5 to +5).

6a. CP Budget and Scale Factor

The CP (centipawn) budget (0–300), shown on the Centipawmeter dial, is a single master gain knob for all attractors. It controls how strongly attractors push the distribution, regardless of the individual slider positions. The budget also names a **real, engine-verified centipawn ceiling** on how far a move may fall below Maia's most-popular choice — that guarantee is enforced at Stage 8 (§9), not by the internal 150-cp-per-log-unit scale factor below, which only sets the push strength.

```
totalAbs =  $\sum |v|$  for all attractor and piece sliders  
scale = cpBudget / (totalAbs × 150) if cpBudget > 0  
and totalAbs > 0 = 0 otherwise  
For each move: prob_new = prob × exp(logBoost) where logBoost =  $\sum$   
(attractor_v × scale × signal)  
At cpBudget=150 with one slider at 1 and all others at 0: scale = 1/150,  
signal = 1 → logBoost = 1 → exp(1) ≈ 2.7× boost
```

Allocating 150 cp of budget on a single maximally-set attractor produces roughly a 2.7× probability boost on moves that fully satisfy that attractor.

6b. Attractor Formulas

Attractor	Left (–) / Right (+)	Signal formula	Notes
Chaos Agent / Simplifier	– Simplifier → low- σ moves + Chaos Agent → high- σ moves	$\log\text{Boost} \pm \text{chaosVal} \times \text{scale} \times \text{signal}$ (signal from MultiPV σ)	Requires MultiPV Stockfish probe. σ = std. dev. of top-N eval scores.
Complicate / Simplify winning	– Simplify when winning + Complicate when winning	Active when eval $\geq +100$ cp. Boosts moves that increase or decrease MultiPV variance.	Only fires in clearly winning positions. Combined with Chaos Agent for full effect.
Space Cadet / Space Waster	– Space Waster → cede space + Space Cadet → reduce weak sqs	$\text{delta} = \text{currentWeakSq} - \text{simWeakSq}$ $\log\text{Boost} \pm v \times \text{scale} \times \tanh(\text{delta}/5)$	Full board attack map computed on simulated position. Captures discovered.
Fort Knox / Glass Cannon	– Glass Cannon → exposed pieces + Fort Knox → more defenders	$\text{delta} = \text{simTotalDefs} - \text{currentDefs}$ $\log\text{Boost} \pm v \times \text{scale} \times \tanh(\text{delta}/3)$	Counts sum of defensive coverage across all bot pieces. Full board attack map.
Gambito / Gambit Shy	– Gambit Shy → avoid sacrifices + Gambito → follow gambit lines	Opening only (< 20 half-moves). ECO: $\log\text{Boost} \pm v \times \text{scale}$ if move is ECO gambit continuation. Fallback: pawn to attacked, undefended sq.	ECO gambit line match takes priority. Structural fallback if ECO data not available.
Trade Seeker / Trade Avoider	– Trade Avoider → no captures + Trade Seeker → captures	Capture: $\log\text{Boost} \pm v \times \text{scale}$ Threat: $\log\text{Boost} \pm v \times \text{scale} \times \tanh(\text{newThreats} / 2)$	Non-captures scored by number of new opponent-piece threats created.
Rigid / Loose Pawn Structure	– Loose → open mobile structure + Rigid → tighter structure	Own pawn moves only. $\text{delta} = \text{currentPenalty} - \text{simPenalty}$ $\log\text{Boost} \pm v \times \text{scale} \times \tanh(\text{delta})$	Penalty = pawn islands + doubled pawns + isolated pawns. $\text{delta} > 0$ = more rigid.
Coffeehouse Hustler / Overthinker	– Overthinker → longer think time + Hustler → shorter think time	Applied to think time (not prob): $\text{thinkMs} \times = (1 - v \times 0.15)$	At +5: ×0.25 (4× faster). At –5: ×1.75 (75% slower). Feeds into pressure.
Luck / Bad Day	– Good day → top of distribution + Bad day → bottom of distribution	Shifts quality range window: $\text{lo} = \text{botDayLower} - v \times 4$ $\text{hi} = \text{_pressureUpper} - v \times 4$	See §8 Move Quality Range for full description.

Panicky / Calm under pressure	– Calm → no temperature boost + Panicky → larger T boost under pressure	Modifies timePressure boost mode. (steady / normal / panicky)	See §4 Pressure Temperature Boost.
Attacker / Peacemaker	– Peacemaker → quiet position + Attacker → maximize threats	$\text{totalThreats} = \sum \text{attacks on each opp. piece}$ $\text{logBoost} += v \times \text{scale} \times \tanh(\text{threats}/6)$	Full board attack map on simulated position. Counts attack coverage across board.

All attractor signals that use tanh map their input to a smooth -1..+1 range, preventing any single move from receiving an unbounded boost.

7. Piece-Type Attractors

Six independent sliders (–5 to +5) bias the bot toward or away from moving each piece type. The formula is the same for all six:

```
logBoost += pieceVals[pieceType] × scale
```

The piece type is determined from the moving piece before the move. The signal is 1 (or 0 for no boost) — there is no continuous signal function as with most strategic attractors. Scale is shared with the strategic attractors so the CP budget controls piece attractor strength alongside everything else.

Piece	Left (–) behaviour	Right (+) behaviour	Best combined with
Pawn ♙	Suppress pawn moves	Prioritise pawn advances	Rigid structure (connected chains)
Knight ♞	De-prioritise knight hops	Knight manoeuvres first	Rigid structure (closed positions)
Bishop ♗	Keep bishops passive	Diagonal play, bishop pair	Loose structure (open diagonals)
Rook ♖	Passive rooks, avoid early trades	File seizure, rook lifts	Open files, trade-seeker
Queen ♛	Conservative queen, avoid exposure	Active queen, queen-led attacks	Chaos Agent (keeps complications)
King ♔	King safety, stay castled	King activity, endgame aggression	Endgame positions, low piece count

8. Move Distribution Filter & Luck

The Move Quality Range dual slider selects which segment of the Maia probability-ranked candidate list the bot samples from. Candidates outside the [lower, upper] percentile window are excluded before temperature sampling and attractor reweighting.

"Quality" here means popularity rank, not engine quality — Maia probability is how often players at the selected rating choose a move. A strong move few players see can sit low in the distribution; real move-quality enforcement is the engine check in §9.

8a. Percentile Band Filtering

```
sorted candidates by probability (highest first) cumulative probability sum = total
band.lo = (lo/100) × total band.hi = (hi/100) × total Include move m if: cumulative_end(m) > band.lo AND cumulative_start(m) < band.hi
```

Default: lo = 0%, hi = 100% (full distribution). Setting lo = 20%, hi = 60% samples only the middle tier — avoiding the top moves (too accurate) and the worst moves (random blunders).

8b. Luck Attractor Shift

The Luck attractor shifts both bounds of the quality window simultaneously:

```
lo_effective = botDayLower - luckVal × 4 hi_effective = pressureUpper - luckVal × 4 luckVal > 0 (Bad day):
window shifts down → samples lower-ranked moves → worse play luckVal < 0 (Good day): window shifts up →
samples top-ranked moves → sharper play
```

pressureUpper is the curve-B degraded upper bound, so luck shift compounds with time pressure effects.

8c. Min-Probability Filter

A single absolute-popularity filter prunes the candidate list before the quality range is applied. (The former relative "blunder-limit" cutoff — which pretended a probability ratio was a centipawn value — has been removed; centipawn enforcement is now the engine-verified check in §9.)

```
absFloor = minProbPct / 100 keep only moves with prob ≥ absFloor (if that empties the list, keep the
single most-popular move)
```

- minProbPct (the "Exclude lowest %" slider): absolute probability floor; removes near-zero candidates. This is an honest distribution control, expressed as a percentage, with no pretence of measuring quality.

9. CP-Budget Acceptance & Degradation Guard (Engine-Verified)

Maia probability is popularity, not quality. Two post-sampling stages use a shallow Stockfish probe to hold the personality to a real centipawn standard. Both run only for personality bots (they need the Stage-5 reweighting flag), only when the sampled pick differs from Maia's most-popular move, and both are fail-open — any probe failure or timeout leaves the sampled move unchanged. The probe reuses the MultiPV complexity machinery with a searchmoves restriction so only the handful of relevant moves are evaluated (depth ~10, ≤ 6 moves).

9a. CP-Budget Acceptance — `applyCpBudgetAcceptance()`

Turns the Centipawmeter into a real centipawn ceiling. When personality reweighting produced a pick different from the most-popular move, the pick, the popular move, and the next few personality favourites are evaluated together. The pick is accepted only if it loses no more than the CP budget versus the popular move; otherwise the bot walks down its own preference order until one fits, falling back to the popular move itself (0 cp by definition).

```
topMove = argmax Maia probability if pick == topMove or reweighting not applied → keep pick evals = SF
probe over [topMove, pick, next favourites] for m in [pick, ...favourites]: if evals[topMove] - evals[m] ≤
cpBudget → play m else → play topMove
```

Stalemate-seeking picks (\$10) are deliberately exempt — throwing material is the whole point, so the budget must not veto them.

9b. Degradation Guard — `applyDegradationEvalGuard()`

Guarantees that a deliberately degraded choice never accidentally out-performs Maia's top move. It is active when Grandmaster Bad Day is on, or when the time-pressure distribution restriction (curve B) is actively narrowing the window. The chosen move and the most-popular move are evaluated, and whichever scores *worse* is played.

```
active if botBadDayMode OR curve-B is narrowing now if pick == topMove → keep evals = SF probe over [pick,
topMove] play the move with the LOWER eval
```

Consequence: Grandmaster Bad Day picks the lowest-probability move above its 4% floor, but if that move happens to be strong (a shot few players see), the guard swaps it back to the mainstream move — the bot is never accidentally brilliant.

10. Draw & Desperation Behaviours

Four opt-in behaviours (in the Move Timing section's "Draws & desperation" group) let a bot handle draw offers, offer draws, and swindle when lost — all judged the way a human of the bot's strength would, not at raw engine accuracy.

10a. Perceived Evaluation — `botPerceivedAdvantageCp()`

Every draw decision uses the bot's **perceived** advantage, not Stockfish's. A shallow eval probe gives the true centipawn advantage from the bot's side; that value is then blurred by rating-scaled Gaussian noise plus a mild self-optimism bias. A novice genuinely misjudges; a master barely does.

```
sigma(elo) = 15 + 700 * exp(-elo / 500) ≈ 225 cp at 600 ELO, ≈ 50 cp at 1500, ≈ 19 cp at 2600  
perceived = trueAdv + gauss()*sigma + 0.25*sigma
```

So a 700-rated bot can believe a lost position is fine (and decline your draw, or offer one from a losing position it thinks is level); a 2400 is almost never fooled.

10b. Accepting & Offering Draws

Behaviour	Control	Rule
Accepts draw offers	toggle + accept-margin (0–300 cp)	On your ½ offer the bot accepts iff its <code><i>perceived</i></code> advantage $\leq$ margin. Declines are wordless
Offers draws	toggle + level-band ($\pm$ cp) + from-move	After its move, in a position that <code><i>feels</i></code> level ($ \text{perceived} \leq \text{band}$) and past the move threshold

10c. Clock Awareness

Draw decisions read the clock (only when the increment is under 10 s, since nobody flags with a healthy increment):

- **Opponent about to flag** (under 20 s, bot comfortably ahead on time): the bot declines instantly with no eval probe and never offers — it is playing for the win on time.
- **Bot itself about to flag** while the opponent is comfortable: it becomes far more agreeable — accept margin widens by 200 cp and its offer band by 150 cp, grabbing the half point even from better positions.

Untimed games and games with a ≥ 10 s increment ignore the clock entirely.

10d. Seek Stalemate When Losing — `_maybeStaleSeek()`

A desperation swindle mode. Once the engine eval says the bot is worse than the threshold and the game has passed the configured move number, candidate weights are re-shaped toward the classic stalemate-trap recipe:

- Moves that reduce the bot's own future mobility (fewer legal replies afterwards → closer to a stalemate shape) are boosted.
- Desperado moves — offering the moved piece for capture — are boosted in proportion to the piece value, most of all when the piece is undefended (dumping the queen is the point).

```
active if staleSeek AND fullmove ≥ fromMove AND eval ≤ -thresholdCp  
weight *= exp( mobilityBoost + desperadoBoost )
```

These picks are exempt from the \$9 CP-budget check. Arming this behaviour also forces the complexity/eval probe every move so the trigger stays current.

11. Preset Personalities

Each preset personality is a named collection of attractor values; loading one sets all sliders to those values (−5 to +5 scale). Some presets also reconfigure the engine, opening repertoire, or draw behaviour and confirm first via a dialog. The table below shows each personality's notable settings.

Personality	Tag	Notable attractor values	Character
Captain Entropy ■	Chaos	chaos:+4, compwin:+4, gambito:+3 trade:+2, spacecadet:+2 hustle:−3, structure:−3	Seeks complications, gambit lines, and tactical chaos. Thinks longer per move (hustle −3).
Norm ■	Order	structure:+4, fortfx:+3, spacecadet:0 chaos:−4, compwin:−4 gambito:−2, hustle:+2	Closes positions, defends solidly. Simplifies when winning. Slightly faster pace.
Attacky McTackerson ■	Captures	trade:+4, attacker:+3, chaos:+2 hustle:−2, structure:−1	Favours captures and threats. Slightly deliberate (hustle −2).
Overthinker ■	Methodical	structure:+3, spacecadet:+3, fortfx:+2 hustle:−4, pressure:−3 chaos:−3, compwin:−2	Maximises board control and structure. Thinks long on every move (hustle −4).
Coffeehouse Hustler ■	Fast	hustle:+5, pressure:+2, luck:+2 gambito:+2, hustle:+5 structure:−2	Plays fast and loose. Phase temperature: T=5 opening → T=0.6 endgame. At high time pressure.
The Blunderer ■	Human	luck:+3, pressure:+5	Plays normally but cracks unpredictably under pressure. Luck shifts toward lower values under pressure.
The Hoarder ■	Material	gambito:−3, trade:−3, fortfx:+2 chaos:−2, hustle:+2, luck:−2	Never sacrifices material. Avoids trades and gambits. Slight faster pace.
Pawn Chain Gang ■	Pawns	structure:+5, fortfx:+1, hustle:+1 chaos:−1, compwin:−2, gambito:−1	Maximises pawn structure. Slightly faster pace.
Spite Check †	Checks	chaos:+3, compwin:+2, attacker:+3 trade:+2, hustle:−2	Always prefers checking moves. Builds up attacks. Slower deliberate pace (hustle −2).
Clock Watcher ■	Clock	compwin:−2, trade:−1, pressure:−3	Conservative when ahead on time, reckless when behind. Calm under pressure.
Grandmaster Bad Day ■	Human	luck:+5, pressure:+2 (Maia 3 @ 2400, picks lowest prob move above 4%)	Strong player having an off day. The \$9 degradation guard prevents it from ever being a blunder.
Drunken Master ■	Human	attacker:+4, chaos:+3, gambito:+3 (Hybrid: 50% Maia 2400 + 50% Maia 1000 per move)	Each move rolls one of two Maia strengths — brilliant one move, blundering the next.
The Drawmeister ½	Human	trade:+4, fortfx:+3, structure:+2 chaos:−4, gambito:−3, attacker:−3 (accepts + offers draws)	Plays for the half point: simplifies, fortresses up, offers/accepts draws (\$10), and offers/accepts draws.

Hustle attractor sign convention: +5 = Coffeehouse Hustler (fast, thinkMs ×0.25). −5 = Overthinker (slow, thinkMs ×1.75).

12. Time Controls

Time controls are defined in TIME_CONTROLS and selected from the bot panel grid. The grid is divided into Blitz (≤ 5 min), Rapid (10–30 min), Classical/Correspondence (60 min+), Infinite (untimed), and a special 90+30 column for FIDE/Candidates format.

Format	Base time	Increment	Bonus	Bonus at	Inc from
Bullet 1+0	1 min	0 s	—	—	—
Blitz 3+2	3 min	2 s	—	—	—
Blitz 5+0	5 min	0 s	—	—	—
Rapid 10+0	10 min	0 s	—	—	—
Rapid 15+10	15 min	10 s	—	—	—
Classical 30+0	30 min	0 s	—	—	—
Classical 60+0	60 min	0 s	—	—	—
Classical 90+0	90 min	0 s	—	—	—
FIDE 90+30 *	90 min	30 s	+30 min	Move 40	Move 41
Untimed	∞	0 s	—	—	—

* 90+30 (FIDE / Candidates): 90 minutes for first 40 moves, then +30 minutes added to both clocks at move 40. 30-second increment applies from move 41 onward. The clockBonusApplied flag prevents the bonus from being awarded twice.

Bonus Time Implementation

```
clockAfterMove(): fullMoveNum = ceil(gameMovesAlgebraic.length / 2) if tc.bonusSecs AND fullMoveNum ≥  
tc.bonusAtMove AND NOT clockBonusApplied: clockTimeW += bonusSecs (capped at 59940 s) clockTimeB +=  
bonusSecs clockBonusApplied = true if clockInc > 0 AND fullMoveNum ≥ tc.incFromMove: add increment to side  
that just moved
```

13. Human Behaviour Flags

Human behaviour flags add realistic timing irregularities and clock-pressure responses. Each flag is independently toggleable. They modify think time or move selection in specific situations.

Flag	When active	Effect
Move Blink (botBehavBlink)	Maia3 mode only. Position entropy < 0.5 (forced or obvious move)	Returns 200–500 ms random pause immediately, skipping full think time calculation. Simulates a human instant
Reconsider (botBehavReconsider)	15% random chance per move	Multiplies computed think time by 1.5–2.5×. Simulates the human hesitation of starting to play a move then reco
Clock Mirror (botBehavClockMirror)	Opponent clock < bot clock × 0.6	Halves think time when the opponent is significantly lower on time. Simulates a human speeding up to maintain
Clock Weaponizer (botWeaponizerEnabled)	Bot clock ahead of opp by more than leadMs	Returns 0 ms think time AND drops Stockfish to floor level. Maximises time pressure on the opponent by playing
Can Flag (botCanFlag)	Always on or off	When OFF: think time capped at max(200 ms, clockMs – 3000 ms). Prevents the bot from flagging itself. When

14. Appendix — Play From Any Position

Beyond bot configuration, games are no longer locked to the standard start. Any finished game, or any loaded PGN, can be reviewed move-by-move and resumed as a new game — against a bot or a friend — from any position along the way.

14a. Review & Replay

- After any game a **Review** button enters replay of the moves just played; step to any position. The last move is highlighted exactly as in live play.
- On the Expert board, notation moves are **clickable** whenever no game is live — clicking one jumps the board to that position.
- Loaded PGNs support a [FEN] set-up header; a position-only PGN opens directly at that position, ready to play.

14b. Resume Play From Here

- **Play from here** starts a bot game from the shown position (the Bot Builder opens; the configured bot then plays on from that point). Repertoire book moves are skipped, but the Lichess explorer stays active — it queries by position, so a classic position still draws real human move frequencies.
- **Invite from here** creates a *private* 2-player room whose game begins at the position (invite link/code only — never posted to the open-challenge board). The server relays a sanitised start position so both boards agree; rematches restart from the same position with colours swapped.
- Saving a from-a-position game writes SetUp/FEN tags (or a complete move list when the prefix is known), so a game can be saved and continued days — or years — later.

End of brief. For implementation details see `src/50-bot-engine.js` (engine), `src/60-bot-ui.js` (config application), `src/10-app-shell.js` (replay / draws / multiplayer), `server.js` (private rooms), and `bot-control-panel.html` (UI and presets).

Generated July 2026 — Blundermind Bot Controls, dev branch.